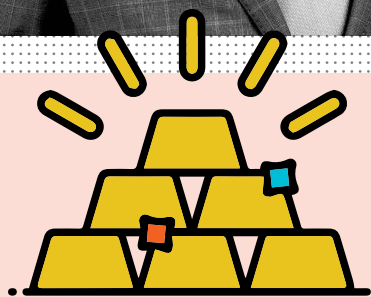


Chandra's Chips

AFTER YEARS OF research and expansion into iPhone manufacturing, under the watchful eyes of Tata Sons Chairman *N. Chandrasekaran*, salt-to-steel conglomerate Tata group is reportedly investing around ₹40,000 crore in Assam to set up a semiconductor chip ATMP (assembly, testing, marking, and packaging) unit. As the next step, the Tata Sons Chairman is looking to venture into chip manufacturing. Unlike other Indian companies, Tata has group semiconductor firm Tejas Networks and a tie-up with Japanese chipmaker Renesas Electronics to its advantage. Will Chandra's move spur other players into action?



SHINING BRIGHT

THE YEAR 2023 was literally a golden year. MCX Gold rose to ₹62,784 per 10 gm on December 22, 2023, from ₹54,556 on December 30, 2022. The yellow metal may continue to shine next year, with the US Fed expected to lower interest rates in mid-2024. "On the MCX, gold is expected to trade higher at ₹57,000-₹67,000 per 10 gm in 2024, while on the COMEX (a global commodity exchange), new highs are expected, with a wide trading range of \$1,850-\$2,250," says Vandana Bharti, AVP, Commodity Research, SMC Global Securities.



MUSK'S MOJO

After buying Twitter (now X) and setting up xAI in 2023, *Elon Musk* is likely to have an eventful 2024 as well. Following his meeting with PM Narendra Modi during the latter's state visit to the US in June 2023, talks about Musk's EV firm Tesla entering India have gathered steam. Starlink, his satellite internet service provider, is also looking to enter India. Overall, it looks like Musk's India plans are finally taking shape.



THE HIGH LIFE

Despite macroeconomic uncertainties, Indians with fat wallets bought luxury homes (priced over ₹40 crore) like never before in 2023. Per Anarock Research, the sales value of such homes rose 247 per cent to ₹4,063 crore in January-September 2023 from ₹1,170 crore in 2022, and the number of deals rose to 58 from 13 in 2022. And, realtors predict a 20-25 per cent rise in such deals in 2024.